

Week 4 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: THE MIDDLE TERM OF FUTURE DANGER

Purpose: Apply Week 4's Whately method to Julius Caesar. Map practical syllogisms and test whether the middle term really connects the premises to the conclusion.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Quote briefly if useful. Your job is to map the reasoning, not retell the scene.

Part 1: Brutus's Main Argument

Part 1 Q1: In the serpent's egg passage, what conclusion is Brutus trying to justify? State it as a clear sentence.

Part 1 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 1 Q2: Write one possible major premise and one possible minor premise behind Brutus's argument.

Part 1 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 2: Terms in the Syllogism

Part 2 Q1: For Brutus's argument, name the minor term, major term, and middle term. Use ordinary language, not just S, P, and M.

Part 2 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 2 Q2: Which premise is the pressure point: the major premise or the minor premise? Explain what Brutus would need to prove.

Part 2 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 3: Cassius's Argument

Part 3 Q1: What conclusion does Cassius want Brutus to reach about Caesar or Rome? State one possible conclusion clearly.

Part 3 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 3 Q2: Choose one possible middle term in Cassius's argument. Explain whether Cassius proves that Caesar belongs under that term.

Part 3 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 4: Comparing the Arguments

Part 4 Q1: Which argument is more logically disciplined: Brutus's serpent's egg argument or Cassius's Colossus argument? Use the terms premise, conclusion, and middle term in your answer.

Part 4 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 4 Q2: Put Whately's Week 4 question to the play: when a speaker argues from possible future danger, what middle term must be proved before violent prevention follows?

Part 4 Q2 ANSWER BOX